

THE POPULATION STORY



At 1.44 billion and growing, India is currently the world's most populous country



The sheer number means an attractive market for companies and investors, which will power India's growth story



This also means the need for productive jobs, health, education and old-age security



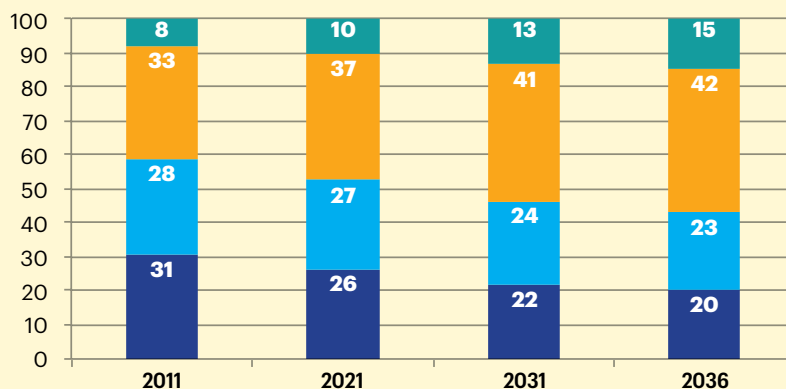
The government is focussing on manufacturing, insurance, housing, urbanisation to meet the needs of the population



More measures are required to ensure that the demographic dividend doesn't turn into a burden

HOW OUR POPULATION CHANGES

● India's working-age population (aged 15-59) is projected to reach 65% by 2036 ● The proportion of youth is projected to decline to 24% of the population in 2031 and to 23% in 2036



● 0-14 YEARS ● 15-29 YEARS ● 30-59 YEARS ● 60+ YEARS
BROAD AGE-GROUP DISTRIBUTION OF THE POPULATION IN %
SOURCE INDIA EMPLOYMENT REPORT 2024, MHFW 2020

soon-to-be-ageing population to ensure that the growth momentum does not fall in the coming years.

India's literacy rate is at 77%, youth unemployment remains high, and the World Bank pegs India's GDP per capita at \$2,484.8, making it a lower middle-income country. India's Human Development Index (HDI) has, however, seen an uptick and the country is ranked in the medium human development category, with a position of 134 out of 193 countries, according to the Human Development Index 2023-24 of the United Nations Development Programme.

In 2022, India saw improvements across all HDI indicators—life expectancy, education, and Gross National Income (GNI) per capita. Life expectancy rose to 67.7 years, expected years of schooling reached 12.6, mean years of schooling increased to 6.57, and GNI per capita touched \$6,951, according to Human Development Index 2023-24 of the United Nations Development

Programme.

As part of its efforts to become a developed economy by 2047, the government hopes to have 100% literacy, lower fertility and infant mortality rates, as well as improvement in the life expectancy rate (see graphic 'Target for 2047').

Improvement in education and skilling must be the most important agenda for the government in the next few years to ensure that people are employable and are able to get jobs in the changing economic dynamics, say experts.

DEMOGRAPHIC ADVANTAGE

Kumar of ISID points out that the demography accords to India a unique advantage in today's world economy: the Indian sub-continent and Africa are the only two regions that can provide future workers. The rest of the world have either aged societies or are ageing very fast. "India has a serious opportu-